PV Digital Twin: User Manual

This manual shows how to run the simulated PV plant and its digital twin, set up a run, inject faults and read the results. No hardware is needed: the plant is simulated.

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1. What the system does

The app runs two models side by side over a day of sunlight and temperature:

- **The plant** is a simulated PV module with sensor noise and a small mismatch from the datasheet. It stands in for the real hardware.
- **The twin** predicts the module's power from the measured irradiance and temperature, using the single diode model.

The **deviation** is how far the plant's measured power is from the twin's prediction, in percent. When it passes a limit the **state** changes:

State	Meaning
Normal	Deviation is inside the warning limit.
Warning	Deviation has passed the warning limit.
Abnormal	Deviation has passed the abnormal limit. An alarm is raised.

You can inject faults into the plant (shading, soiling and so on) and watch the twin catch them.

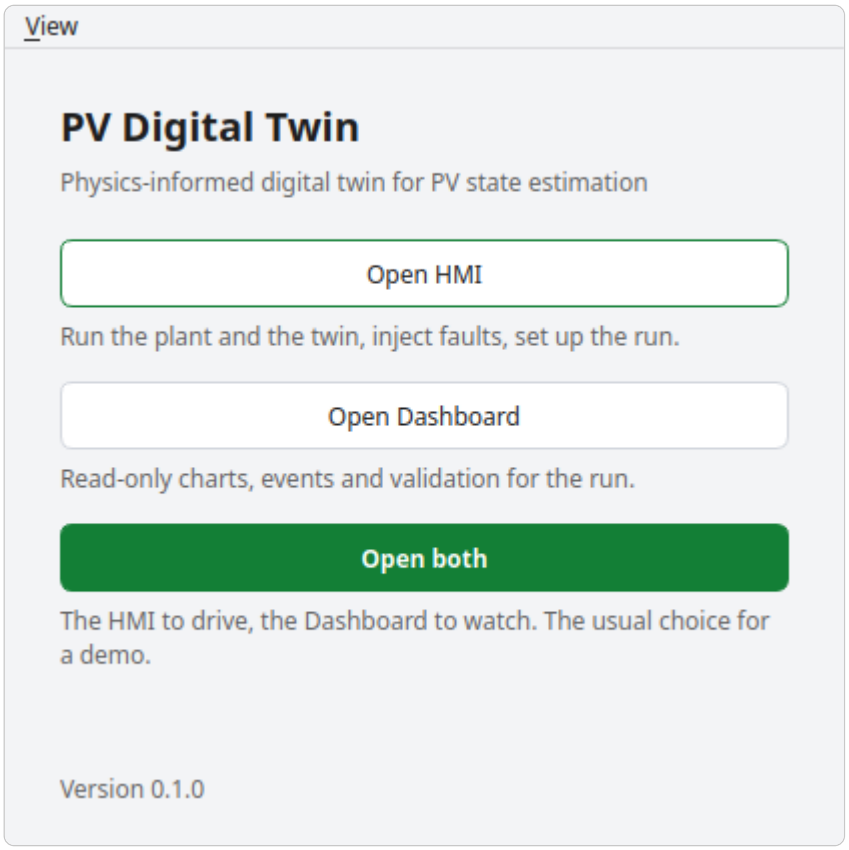
There are two windows. The **HMI** is where you drive the run. The **Dashboard** is a read-only view of the same run, with charts and a validation report.

2. Starting the app

From the repository root:

```
uv run pvysics
```

The launcher opens.



Button	Opens
Open HMI	The window where you run the plant and the twin, inject faults and set up the run.
Open Dashboard	The read-only charts, events and validation.
Open both	Both windows on the same run. The usual choice for a demo.

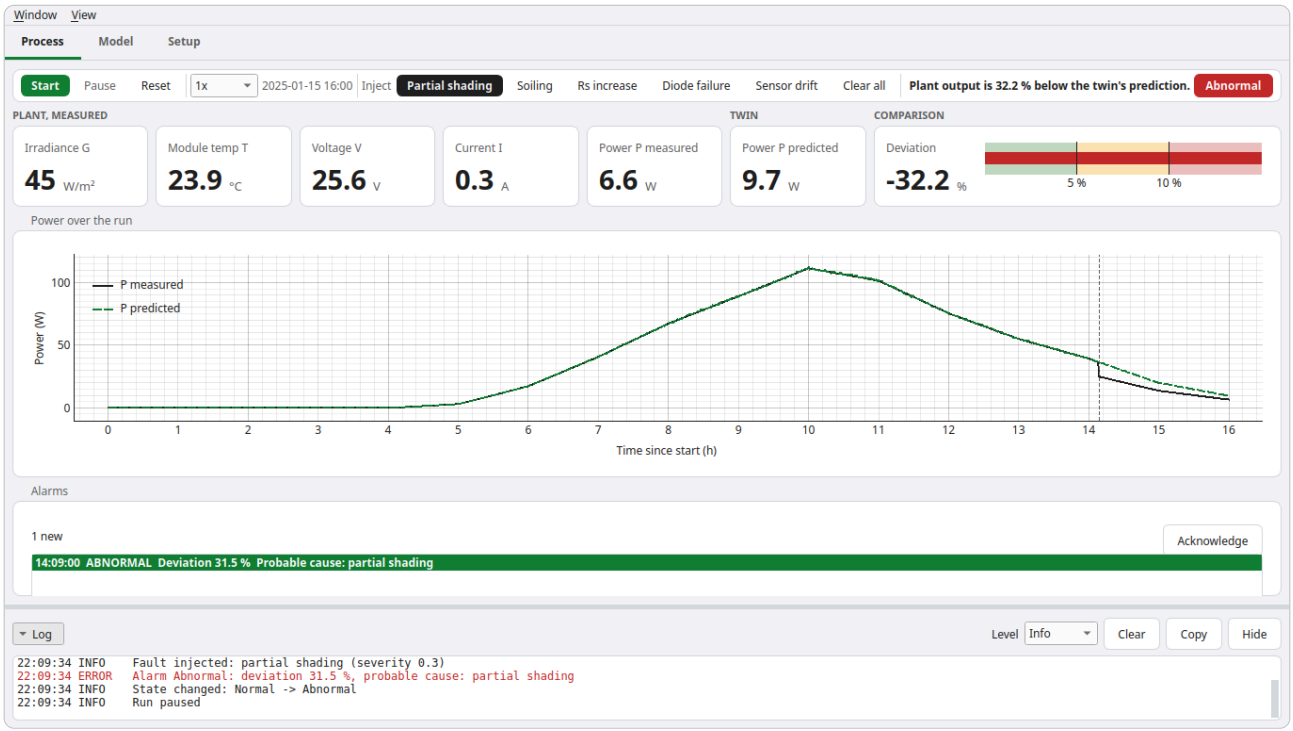
To skip the launcher, use `uv run pvysics --hmi`, `--dashboard` or `--both`. Closing the last window quits the app.

3. The HMI

The HMI has three tabs: **Process**, **Model** and **Setup**.

3.1 Process

This is where you run the simulation.



Toolbar (the row at the top)

Control	What it does
Start	Plays the run from the beginning, or resumes it after a pause.
Pause	Holds the run where it is.
Reset	Clears the run so it can start again.
Speed (1x to 28800x)	How many times faster than real time the run plays. At 28800x a whole day plays in about 3 seconds.
Clock	The simulated date and time of the current sample.
Inject buttons	Partial shading, Soiling, Rs increase, Diode failure, Sensor drift. Click one to inject that fault into the plant. A fault that is on shows as a dark button. Use **Clear all** to remove faults.
Clear all	Removes every injected fault.

Before the run starts, the toolbar shows only the controls. Once the run is playing, the right end shows a one-line sentence about the current state and a coloured pill (Normal, Warning or Abnormal).

Measurement tiles

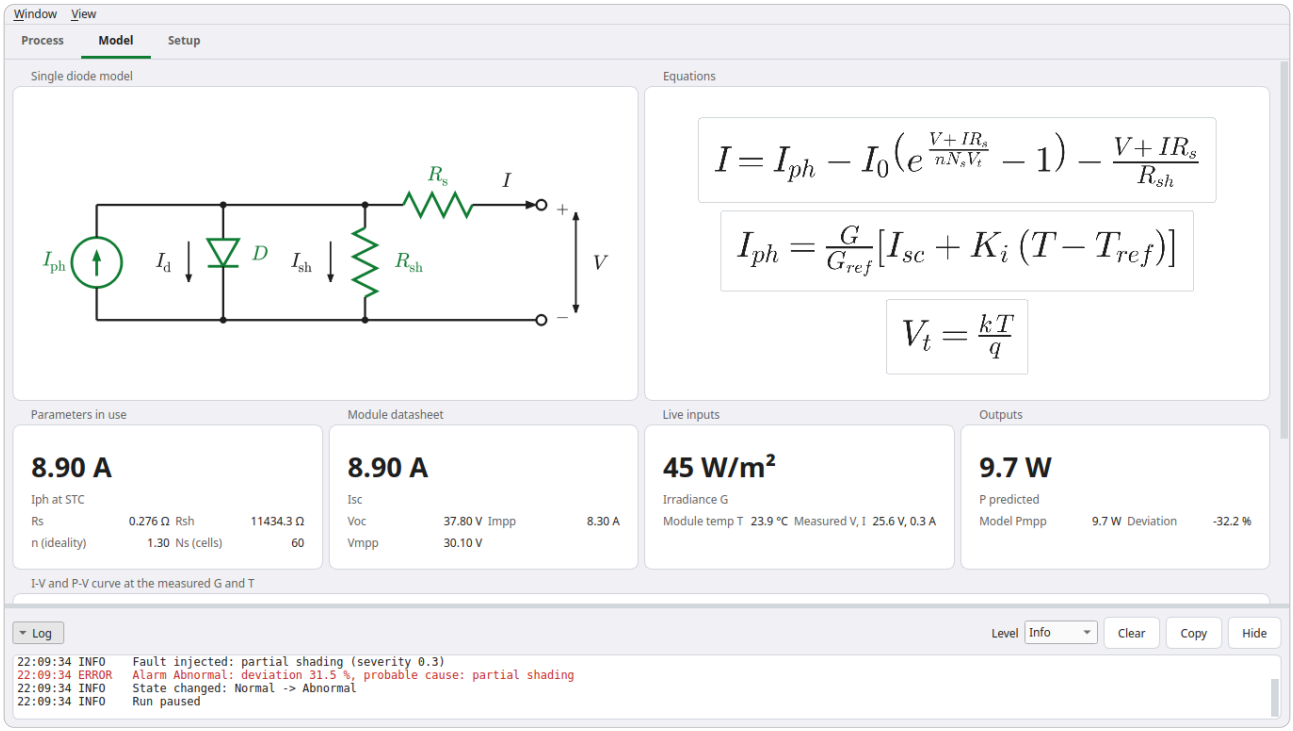
Group	Tiles
Plant, measured	Irradiance G, module temperature T, voltage V, current I, measured power P
Twin	Predicted power P
Comparison	Deviation, with a bar showing the 5 % and 10 % limits (green is Normal, amber is Warning, red is Abnormal)

Power over the run plots measured power (black) against predicted power (green, dashed). A dashed vertical line marks the moment a fault was injected.

Alarms lists each alarm with its time, state, deviation and probable cause. The header says how many are new. Press **Acknowledge** to mark them as seen.

3.2 Model

This tab shows what the twin is computing.



- The **circuit** of the single diode model and its **equations**.
- **Parameters in use**: the photocurrent, series and shunt resistance and ideality factor that the twin fitted from the datasheet.
- **Module datasheet**, **Live inputs** and **Outputs**: the values going in and the power coming out for the current sample.
- Below these, the **I-V and P-V curves** at the measured irradiance and temperature.

3.3 Setup

Setup holds every setting for the next run. See section 5.

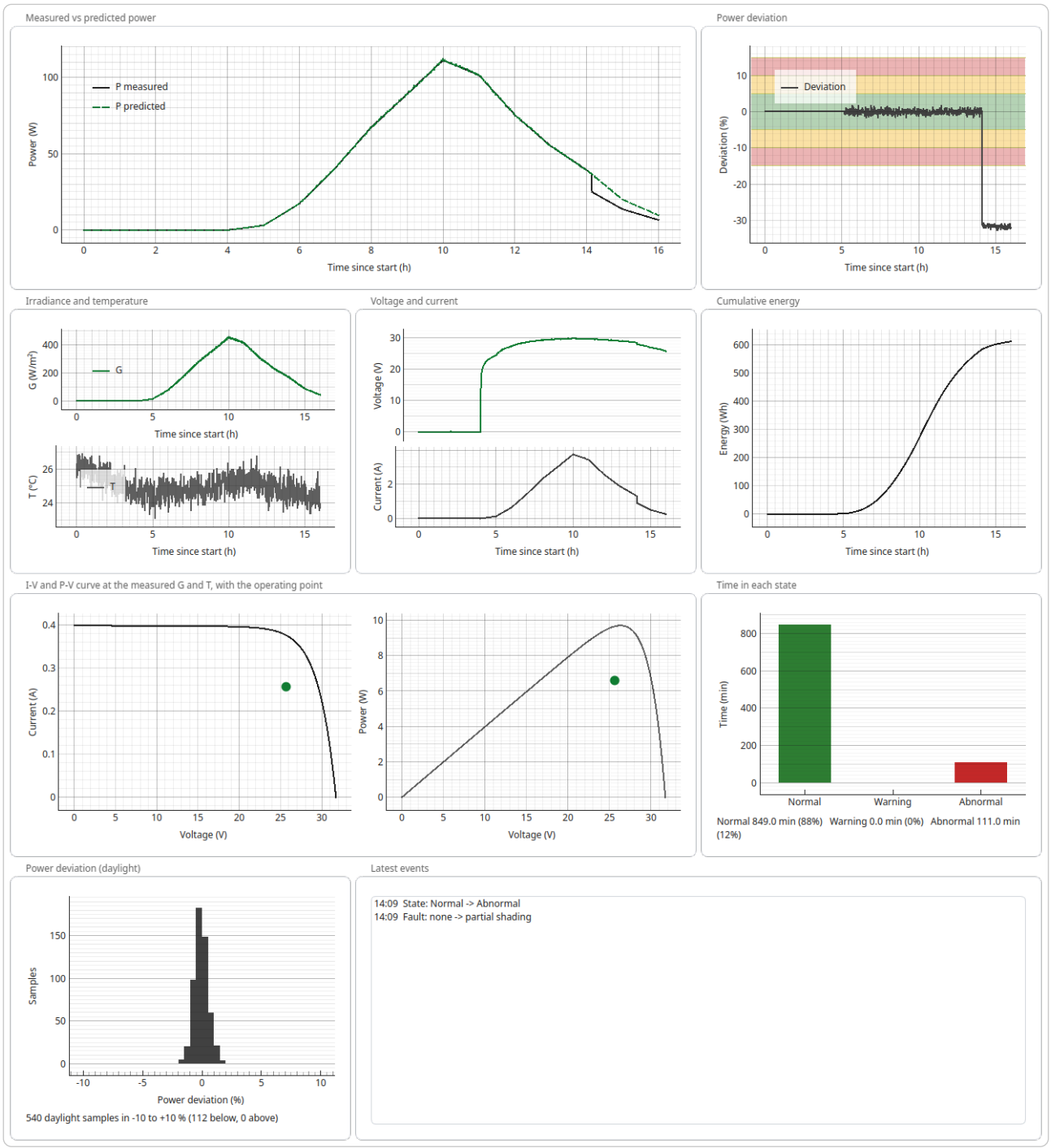
4. The Dashboard

Use the Dashboard to watch a run. It changes nothing.

4.1 Overview



- **The tiles at the top** show measured power, predicted power, deviation, the state and the energy produced so far.
- **The charts** below scroll with the page: measured against predicted power, the deviation against its limits, irradiance and temperature, voltage and current, the I-V and P-V curves with the operating point, cumulative energy, a histogram of deviations, and the time spent in each state.



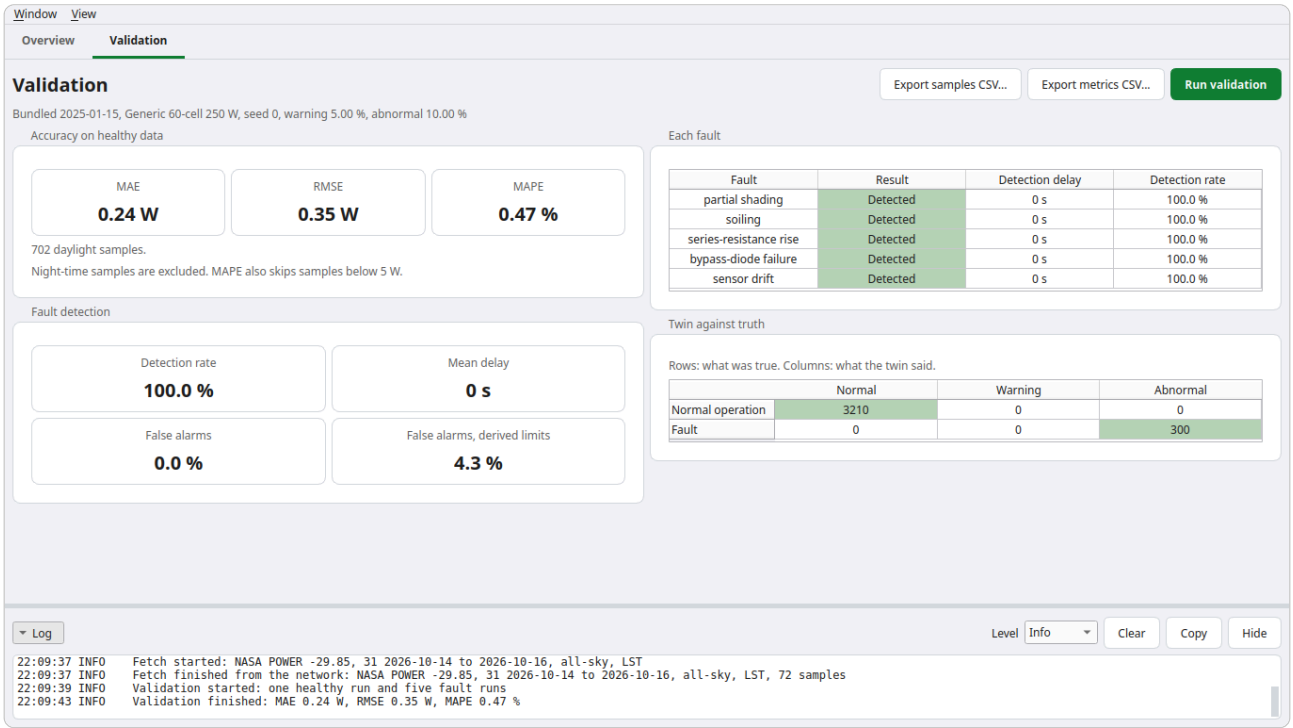
If you open the Dashboard before a run, it says there is no run in progress and offers **Open HMI**.

4.2 Validation

Validation tests the twin against known answers. It runs one healthy day and one day for each of the five faults.



Press **Run validation**. The window stays usable while it runs.



Result	What it tells you
MAE, RMSE, MAPE	How closely the twin's power matches the healthy plant. Night samples are excluded, and MAPE also skips samples under 5 W.
Detection rate	The share of fault samples the twin flagged as Abnormal.
Mean delay	How long after injection the twin noticed.
False alarms	How often the healthy run was flagged, at your configured limits and at limits derived from the healthy run's own noise.

Each fault	Whether each of the five faults was detected, how fast, and at what rate.
Twin against truth	A table of what was true (rows) against what the twin said (columns). Green cells are correct.

Export samples CSV... and **Export metrics CSV...** save the data behind the results.

5. Setting up a run

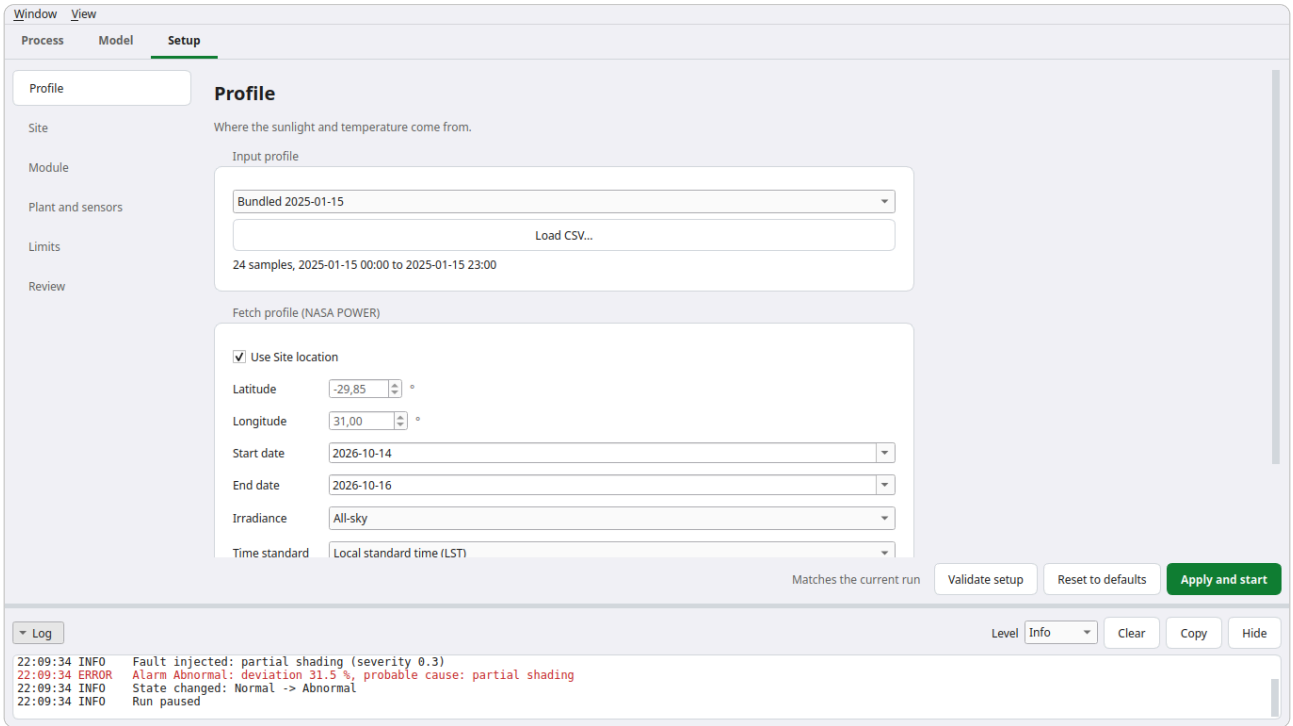
Open the HMI's **Setup** tab. The sections are listed on the left. Click one to see its page.

Nothing changes until you press **Apply and start**. The bar along the bottom shows whether your edits differ from the current run ("Matches the current run" or unapplied changes). It also holds three buttons:

Button	What it does
Validate setup	Checks every value and reports problems. It starts nothing.
Reset to defaults	Puts every control back to its default. It applies nothing.
Apply and start	Checks the setup and starts a new run from the beginning.

Each number field holds only the number. Its unit is the grey label beside it.

5.1 Profile



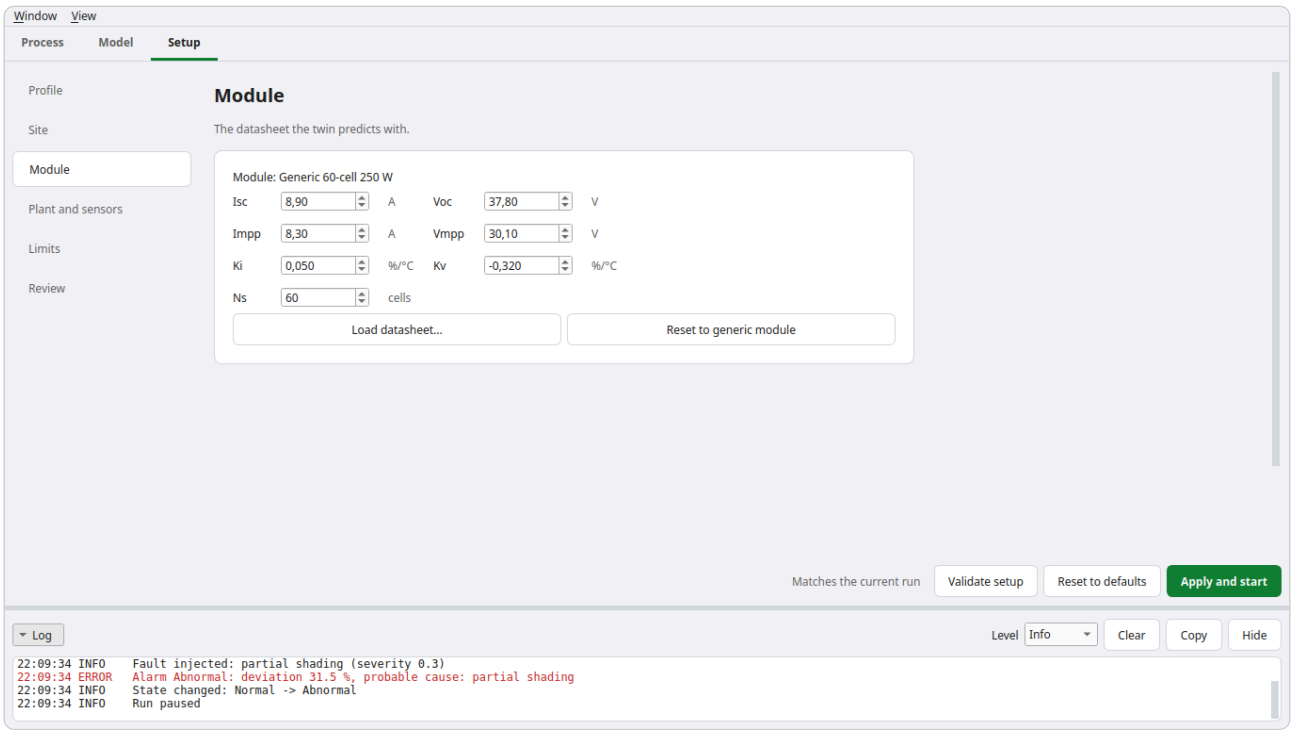
The profile is the day of irradiance and temperature that drives the run.

- Choose a bundled day from the list, or press **Load CSV...** for your own file (section 6).
- **Fetch profile (NASA POWER)** downloads real data for a place and dates. Tick **Use Site location** to use the latitude and longitude from the Site page, or untick it to type your own. Choose the start and end dates, the irradiance type and the time standard, then press **Fetch**. **Preview...** shows the fetched data before you use it. Fetches are cached, so a repeat fetch works offline.

5.2 Site

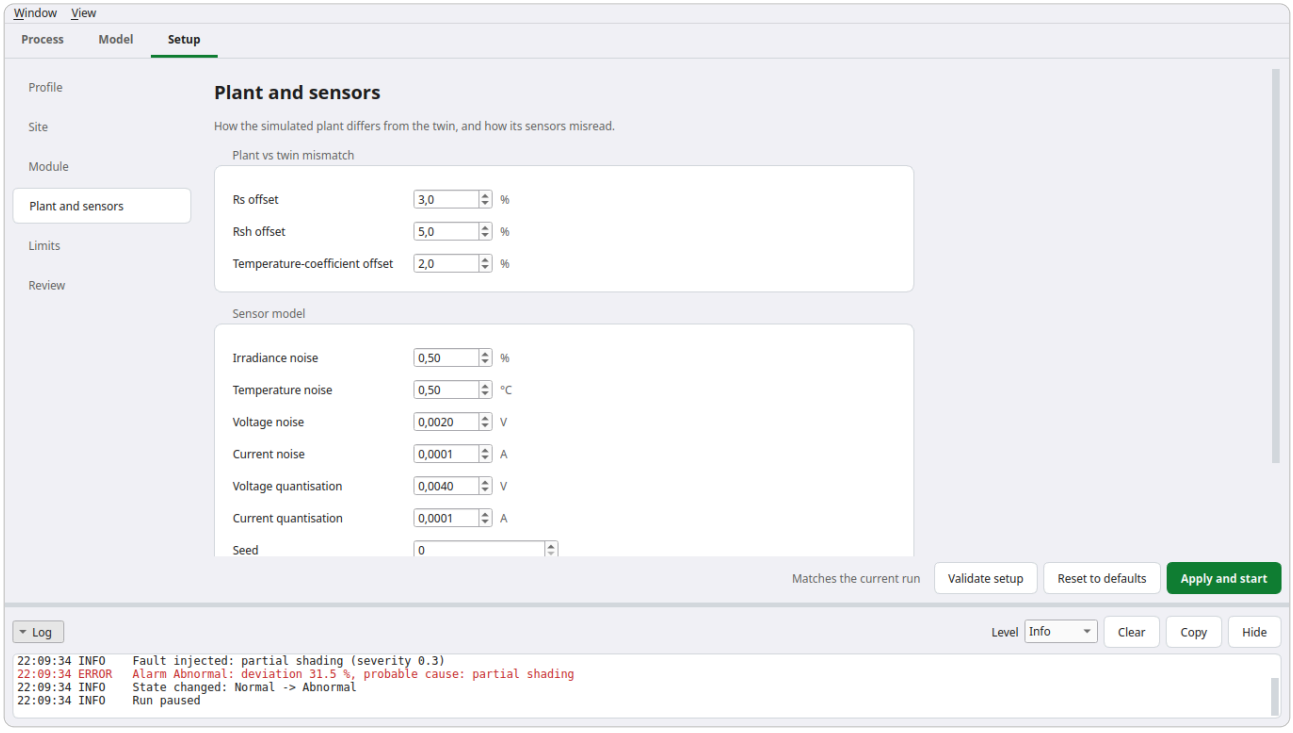
Where the plant is (latitude, longitude, tilt and azimuth). It labels the run and sets the default fetch position. It does not change the physics.

5.3 Module



The datasheet the twin predicts with: Isc, Voc, Impp, Vmpp, the temperature coefficients Ki and Kv, and the cell count Ns. Edit any value, press **Load datasheet…** to read a file, or press **Reset to generic module** to return to the generic 60-cell 250 W module.

5.4 Plant and sensors



- **Plant vs twin mismatch**: how far the simulated plant's series resistance, shunt resistance and temperature coefficient are from the twin's. A larger mismatch makes a larger healthy deviation.
- **Sensor model**: the noise on each sensor, the step size of the voltage and current readings, and the random **Seed**. The same seed gives the same run every time.

5.5 Limits

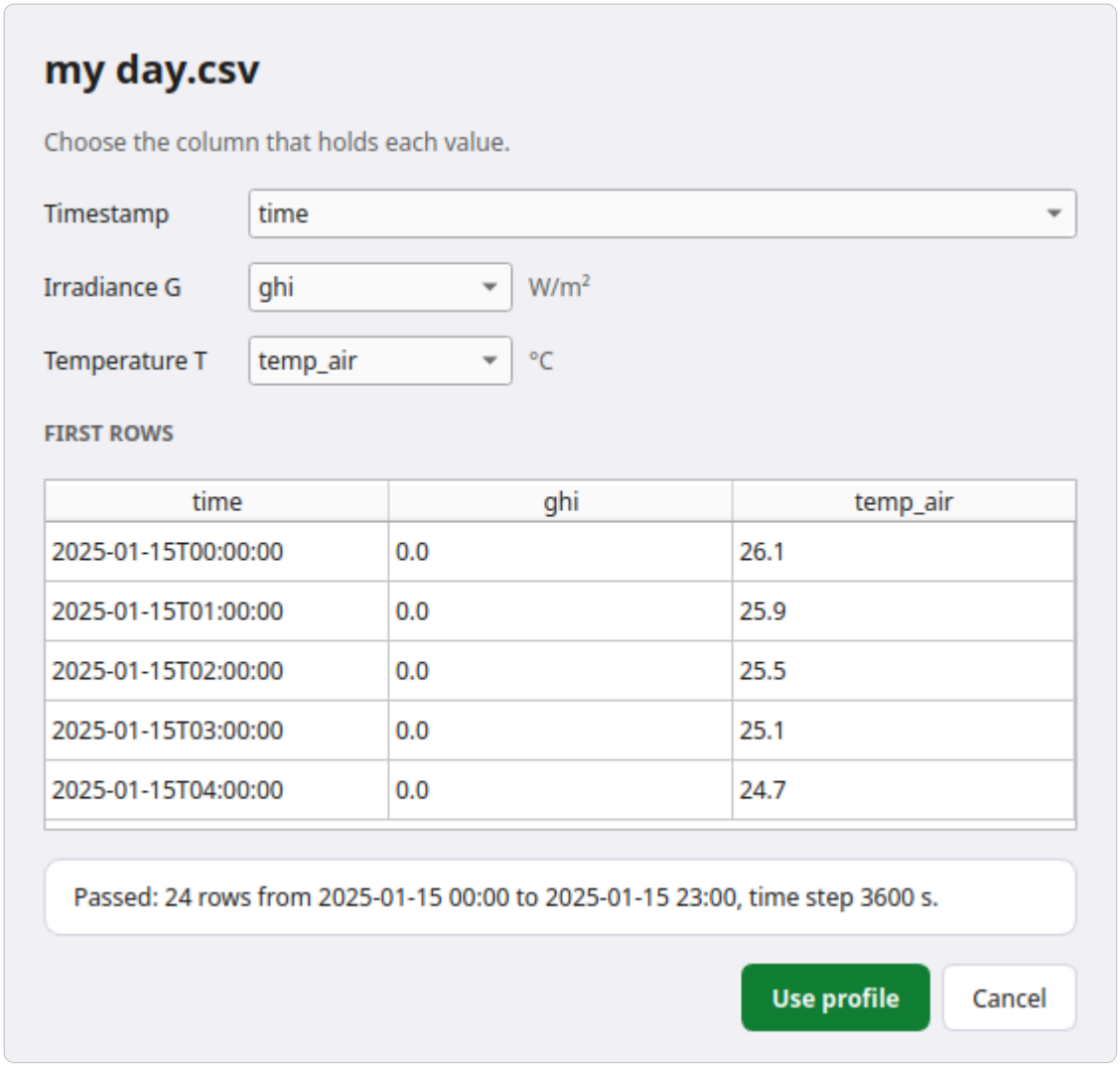
The warning and abnormal limits, in percent. **Derive from healthy run** sets them from a healthy simulated day: the mean deviation plus two and three standard deviations.

5.6 Review

A summary of what the next run will use. Check it, then press **Apply and start**.

6. Loading your own data

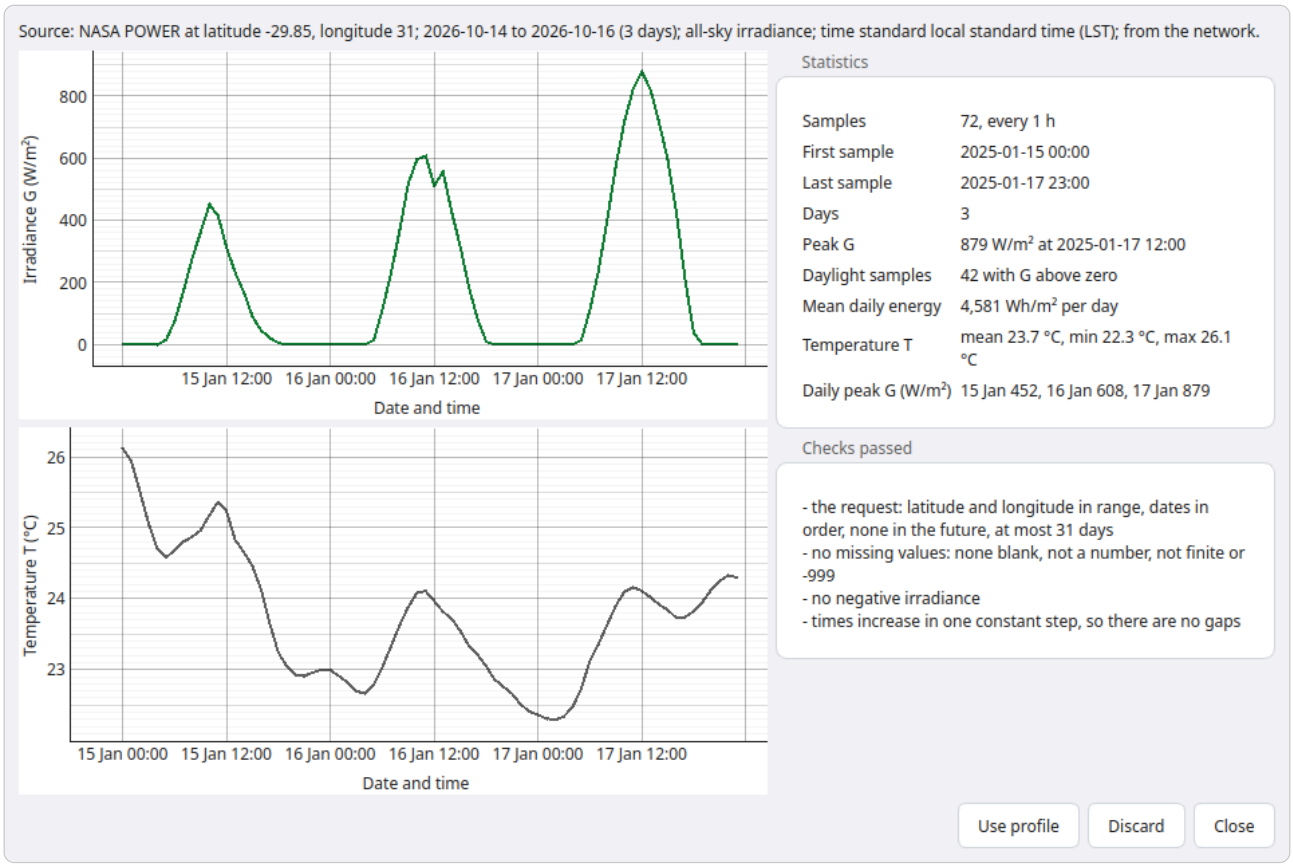
Press **Load CSV…** on the Profile page and choose a file. The file needs a header row, a timestamp column, an irradiance column (W/m²) and a temperature column (°C).



1. The dialog guesses each column from its name. Change a choice if it is wrong. NASA POWER files with `YEAR, MO, DY, HR` columns are recognised.
2. The **first rows** table shows what the file holds.
3. The check line says **Passed** with the number of rows, the date range and the time step, or **Rejected** with the reason.
4. **Use profile** is enabled only when the file passes. Press it, then **Apply and start**. **Cancel** keeps the previous profile.

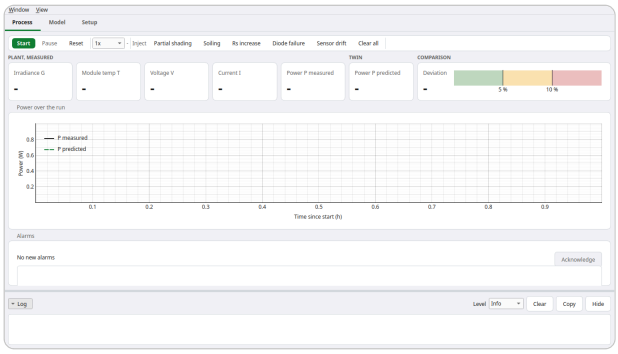
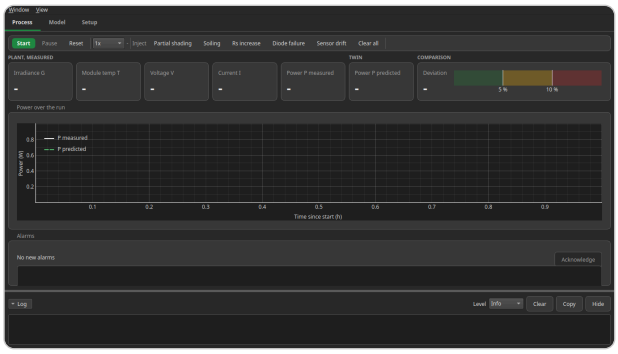
A file is rejected if its times do not increase by one fixed step, any value is missing or not a number, or irradiance is negative.

When you fetch from NASA POWER, **Preview…** opens the fetched profile for inspection before it is used.



7. Themes and the log

Themes. The app follows your system's light or dark setting. In the **View** menu, choose **System**, **Light** or **Dark** to override it.

Light	Dark
	
	

The log. Each window has a log pane along its bottom. It lists what the app is doing as time, level and message.

- Drag the bar above it to resize it, or press the **Log** arrow to collapse it to its header.
- **Level** filters by Debug, Info, Warning or Error. Warnings are amber and errors are red.
- **Clear** empties it, and **Copy** puts the visible lines on the clipboard.
- **Hide** removes the pane. **View > Show log** (Ctrl+L) brings it back.

Both windows show the same log.

8. Quick recipes

Watch a fault being caught

1. Press **Open both** on the launcher.
2. In the HMI, set the speed to `600x` and press **Start**.
3. Once the plant output has risen, click **Partial shading**.
4. Watch the deviation tile and bar, the state pill and the alarm. The Dashboard shows the same event.

Run on real weather

1. Setup > Site: enter the plant's latitude and longitude.
2. Setup > Profile: pick dates, press **Fetch**, press **Preview...**, then **Use**.
3. Press **Apply and start**.

Check the twin's accuracy

1. Open the Dashboard and go to **Validation**.
2. Press **Run validation** and read the tiles and tables.
3. Use **Export metrics CSV...** to keep the numbers.

Start over

Setup > **Reset to defaults**, then **Apply and start**.

9. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
The Dashboard says "No run in progress".	Press **Open HMI** and start a run there.
A CSV is rejected.	Read the reason in the dialog. Check that the columns are mapped right and the times step evenly with no gaps.
A fetch fails.	NASA POWER needs an internet connection. The log has the reason. A date range you fetched before still loads from the cache.
The state stays Normal after injecting a fault.	At night there is too little light to compare, so no state is shown. Run on until the sun is up.
Changes on Setup have no effect.	Press **Apply and start**. Edits apply only then.
The log pane has disappeared.	Press Ctrl+L, or use **View > Show log**.